

PSILOCYBIN MUSHROOM MICRODOSING GUIDE



AMEYALLI

ameyalli.space



INTRODUCTION

Microdosing is defined as the practice of ingesting one-tenth of a therapeutic dose (or macrodose) at regular intervals to benefit from the therapeutic effects of the medicine without the more intense effects. By definition a microdose should be non-perceptible or nearly non-perceptible so that the microdoser can continue all of their daily routines without interruption nor modification. This method is a slow and steady therapeutic process designed to allow the microdoser to experience gradual changes that can be more easily integrated into everyday life.

BENEFITS OF MICRO COMPARED TO MACRO

Microdosing and macrodosing are both powerful and uniquely beneficial methods of working with psilocybin mushrooms. Each method has its advantages and strengths and neither is a complete substitute for the other. In fact, combining these methods is a great way to work with the medicine.

Macro doses are used to generate more movement in the person and often involve a great deal of catharsis. This method is a virtual reset button for those that really feel stuck. This method is also much more intense and may not be possible for those that suffer from certain mental or physical health problems or that are on specific medications that make them ineligible for working at the macro level.

Microdoses are a slower and gentler method that allows the person to more easily “digest” or integrate the changes into everyday life because it is done at regular intervals. For some, microdosing may take much longer to effect change and the changes may be more subtle or shorter lived but they may also be more solid due to integration happening alongside dosing.

BENEFITS AND EFFECTS

PSILOCYBIN: THE GREAT SENSITIZER & REFRAMER

Psilocybin has an incredible capacity to help sensitize us to our emotions and at the same time help us reframe those emotions so that we can either let them go if they don't serve us or integrate them if they do serve us.

When this letting go occurs, we can find ourselves in a space of peace, gratitude, and compassionate self-acceptance.

“IT IS IMPORTANT TO EXPECT NOTHING, TO TAKE EVERY EXPERIENCE, INCLUDING THE NEGATIVE ONES, AS MERELY STEPS ON THE PATH, AND TO PROCEED.”

— RAM DASS

PSILOCYBIN: THE GREAT MIRROR

Psilocybin (as well as all plant medicines) can often work like a magic mirror to reflect back to us:

- Ways of thinking that have become automatic or limiting that we have become so used to that we stopped noticing long ago.
- The many ways that we subconsciously berate ourselves on a daily basis.
- The ways we mistreat others and how that is linked to how we treat ourselves.
- The ways that we limit our love for ourselves and others because of fear of rejection and abandonment.
- The ways that we complicate things in life that are really so simple and clear.

This mirroring can feel like the medicine is scolding us, but it is just a mirroring of our internal processes so we can be aware.

EXPECTED EFFECTS

Microdosing should ideally be in the imperceptible or barely-perceptible range so that it doesn't interfere with your daily life during your course of treatment. That being said there are plenty of effects that you might experience as a result of the microdose working such as:

- Greater sense of connection with loved ones and with nature

- A greater sense of awareness of how your actions and those of others affect you and others
- More compassion for yourself and others
- A slowing down of the pace of life
- More attention and easing into the present moment
- An opening to more possibilities and a loosening of rigidity in how things have to be in life
- Many other beautiful gifts that will unfold for you if you are receptive to seeing them...

POSSIBLE UNDESIRABLE EFFECTS

Some people can experience effects that are unpleasant or inconvenient:

- Difficulty sleeping. If you take your microdose in the early morning and you find it hard to sleep at night, try a nighttime dose at least once to see if that helps.
- Fatigue. If it makes you fatigued try dosing at different times of the day to see if this changes. It may also be a factor when you first start that may lift as your body becomes more used to the medicine.
- Extra anxiety. For those with anxiety, microdosing can increase it. This can be very discouraging for those that are affected this way because it can make it feel like the microdosing is making things worse. Other than lowering the dose there is not much that can be done for this because it is probably a necessary way for you to process.





RECIPE FOR SUCCESS

There are some key factors that separate successful microdosing from less successful microdosing. By following this advice, you will nearly guarantee your success.

Following this advice can be challenging because it implies learning new things and for this reason this guide is very detailed so that you can fully understand each of these areas and in the process become somewhat of an expert.

1. SOURCING

2. COURSE OF TREATMENT & PROTOCOL

3. PRECISION DOSING AND PREPARATION

4. FINDING YOUR OPTIMAL DOSE

5. USING A PROVEN DELIVERY METHOD

6. INTENTION SETTING & MANAGING EXPECTATIONS

7. MAKING SPACE TO SUPPORT THE PROCESS

8. INTEGRATION

1. SOURCING

SOURCING FROM OTHERS

Sourcing is the biggest hurdle to get over due to psilocybin's illegal status. The best way to find a source is to have conversations with people you know about the re-emergence of psychedelic medicine in academia and clinical trials. This is a good way to gauge the openness of the people you know because you will be referring to ways that mushrooms are being used legitimately in academia and in medicine. If you are concerned about the safety of mentioning these things with certain people you can refer to it in such a way that others may think you are uncertain of it. Their response to you and your uncertainty will tell you a lot about their perspective (or lack of perspective) about it and this will indicate to you whether you should dig further with them or back off. Once you have established who knows something about them and what their opinion about it may be, you can feel more assured about asking if they know any way to source them. Younger more open-minded folks may be a better demographic to focus on.

Asking for sources online is not recommended because there are lots of scammers and doing so can often get you banned from social media groups (even when they are focused on microdosing).

HOW TO KNOW A SOURCE IS LEGITIMATE

This is a nearly impossible task. You can only confirm a good source by experiencing the product they deliver. That being said there are some questions that you should ask your source before buying from them:

1. What species of psilocybin mushrooms are available?
2. If the species is *Psilocybe Cubensis* (or just *Cubensis* for short), which strain is it?
3. How potent is the species (and strain if *Cubensis*) compared to the average potency?
4. What is the smallest amount I can buy?
5. Are the mushrooms cracker dry?

If they cannot answer the first three questions, it is likely not a good idea to buy from them. Always buy the smallest amount possible. You are microdosing and will not need all that much for your first course of treatment. You may need 6 grams (quarter of an ounce) at the most to supply you with your first course of treatment.

The mushrooms should always be cracker dry. If they are not, they can mold or degrade quickly. Be very careful though. Mushrooms are often sold with silica packets dispersed amongst them to retain dryness. It would be a shame to spoil your mushrooms by grinding them up with the silica packets.

Many sources may ask you if you want to buy

microdoses in capsules from them. My recommendation is to kindly decline because already encapsulated products may make it impossible to know the precise dose and to find your optimal dose.

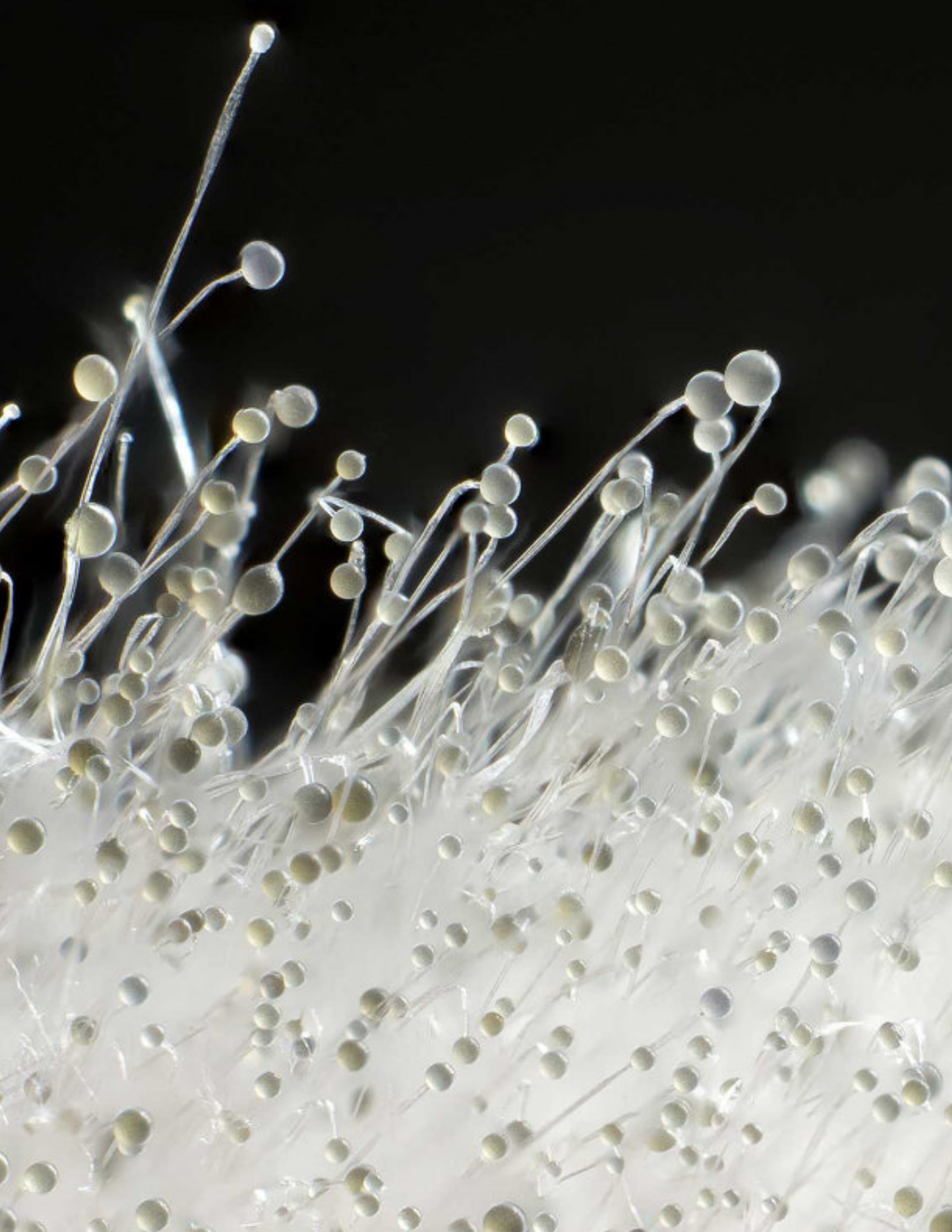
CULTIVATION

The other option for sourcing is to learn how to cultivate them yourself. This option implies a whole lot of learning and a bigger investment in both money and time. This is a good option for someone that is a jack-of-all-trades type that is not afraid of self-taught skills. There are many resources for learning how to do this online such as shroomery.org and Facebook groups with the same name. Cultivation is beyond the scope of this guide.

MUSHROOM SPECIES, VARIETIES, AND POTENCIES

The most common (or most available) species of *Psilocybe* mushrooms is called *Psilocybe Cubensis* (or *P. Cubensis* or just *Cubensis* for short). This species has been the species of choice for cultivators due to its ease of cultivation. Because of the extensive amount of cultivation done over the years, there are lots of genetics that have been isolated, and subsequently named, within the *Cubensis* strain.

The average potency of the *Cubensis* species, between .6% and .9% total tryptamine





"Dot Cubes" by Diego Fernando Peña

content. These numbers are used as a benchmark for dosing macro and microdoses. There are some varieties of Cubensis that are up to 2 to 2.5 times more potent than the average and there are some non Cubensis species that have up to 5 to 6 times more potency than the average. This is why it is important for your supplier to tell you what species and what variety (if it's a Cubensis) so you will know how much stronger they may be than the average.

2. COURSE OF TREATMENT & PROTOCOL

COURSE

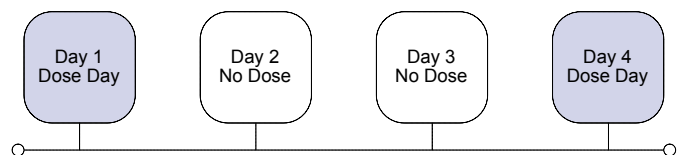
Each round of treatment should last two months. After two months you should take a two week or more break. This will help to completely reset your tolerance level and will also give you the space to see how long the results last while not microdosing and to what degree they remain or not. This is important to do so that you don't become dependent on your microdosing and so that you can experience the benefits for periods of time (no matter how short) without being under the influence of the microdose.

Committing to a full course of two months before deciding that it is working or not is highly recommended. It could take multiple courses for you to reach your goals, but if you give yourself at least one complete one then you will know if microdosing is for you or not.

PROTOCOL

The protocol you should use is called the Fadiman Protocol. It is a one day on two days off protocol. The reason for this protocol is because psilocybin has a very strong tolerance factor and if you take it every day you build a tolerance and it starts to lose effectiveness. Also, like the 2-week break, your days off give you the opportunity to feel the after effects and really notice how the medicine is affecting you.

You should plot out your dosing days in your calendars with reminders so that you can remain as consistent as possible.



TIMING

The best time to microdose is in the morning so that you can benefit from the effects the entire day. If your schedule does not permit this then you really can take it any time of the day. However, taking it at night to close to bed time can cause some people to lose sleep. This is not always the case though. For some that may suffer insomnia...taking it at night could make it worse or make it better. If this is you, you will need to figure it out by experimenting a little.

3. PRECISION DOSING & PREPARATION

Precise dosing, when working with mushrooms, is very important whether it is microdosing or macrodosing, but with microdosing it is even more important because of the smaller doses involved.

PREPARATION

You should prepare your mushrooms by first weighing out the amount of your day's dose in whole mushrooms. You should use a dedicated coffee grinder to grind your day's dose and then weigh out the exact amount in powder form.

WEIGHING AND APPROPRIATE SCALES

The only way to dose precisely is by using a jewelry scale that is accurate up to .001 grams (or 1 milligram). Using a scale that doesn't have the precision of .001 will result in inaccurate measurements and imprecise doses.

Not all scales are made the same so below is an amazon wish list I created with products I think will work well for you:

https://www.amazon.com/-/es/hz/wishlist/ls/32GGDFDJGTG1K?ref=list_d_wl_lfu_nav_5

Whatever scale you end up buying it should come with at least one weight to calibrate it.

POTENCY OF THE MUSHROOMS

The potency of psilocybin mushrooms varies widely not just between species but also between strains of the same species and within the same species and strains depending on the cultivator's cultivation practices and the growing environment of the mushrooms.

If you'd like to take the guess work out of the task you can order this testing kit online:

<https://uswebshop.miraculix-lab.com/product/psilo-qtest/>

With this kit you will be able to determine the potency of your exact batch of mushrooms by seeing where on the scale it falls.

ESTIMATING STARTING DOSE

	50mg (.05 grams)	25mg (.025 grams)	10mg (.01 grams)	5mg (.005 grams)
Supplier Says	Average potency P. Cubensis	Higher than average potency P. Cubensis	Much higher than average potency P. Cubensis	Extra potent non-Cubensis species
Test Kit Shows	6mg or .6% range	8mg .8% to 10mg 1% range	12mg 1.2% to 15mg 1.5%	More than 15mg 1.5%

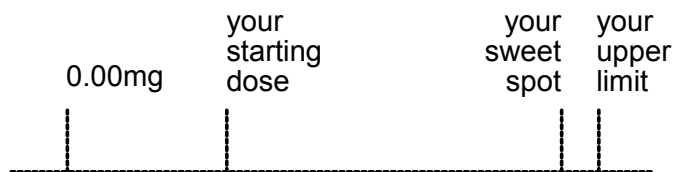
The next step is optimizing your dose so if the above estimation isn't correct, you will soon know and you will be able to adjust your next dose accordingly.





4. FINDING YOUR OPTIMAL DOSE

Because dosing is so imprecise by nature and every person varies widely in sensitivity the optimal dose finding process is experimental in nature. This means that you MUST take your starting dose on a day when you will not have anything important to do for at least a few hours (especially driving). This way if your starting dose is too high for you it won't leave you stuck. It is rare that these quite low starting doses would be so strong that the person wouldn't be able to function, but since we don't know it is better to aim on the side of safety.



SIGNS YOU'VE REACHED YOUR UPPER LIMIT

- Perceptual changes, such as visual or auditory distortions.
- Increased feelings of anxiety or unease (meaning more than your baseline) that prevent you from functioning.
- Emotional intensity that makes it difficult to function.
- Difficulty concentrating or processing information that make it difficult to function

- Noticeable physical sensations, such as tingling or changes in body temperature, or sweating.

SEARCHING FOR YOUR UPPER LIMIT

- If your very starting dose is at or beyond your upper limit from day 1 then back off from it with each subsequent dose by 10% until you aren't at or beyond your upper limit anymore. Congrats you've found your optimal dose (aka sweet spot).
- If your very first dose is not at your upper limit then add 10% to each subsequent dose until you reach or upper limit. Then go back to the dose right before you hit your upper limit. Congrats you've found your optimal dose (aka sweet spot).

VARIABILITY OF THE SWEET SPOT

Your sweet spot can change over time. If you become more sensitive to your dose over time then you can dial it back 5% at a time to chase the optimal dose.

**“IT'S VERY HARD TO GROW
BECAUSE IT'S DIFFICULT TO
LET GO OF THE MODELS OF
OURSELVES IN WHICH WE'VE
INVESTED SO HEAVILY.”**

— RAM DASS

5. USING A PROVEN DELIVERY METHOD

Psilocybin mushrooms are comprised of many components. The active components are Psilocybin (mostly) and Psilocin (to a lesser degree in most species and strains). The Psilocybin is actually just a stabilized form of Psilocin that once broken down by your stomach acid becomes Psilocin and creates the healing and psychedelic effects of the mushrooms. Another component of the mushrooms (and all raw mushrooms) is Chitin. Chitin is a non-digestible (by humans anyway) fiber that accounts for a large party of the difficulty in digesting mushrooms.

Between the need to digest the psilocybin so that it is available as Psilocin in our bodies and the difficulty in digesting the Chitin, ingesting psilocybin mushrooms can make for a lot of burden on the stomach.

Thankfully, soaking the ground up powder for that day's dose in enough lemon juice to barely cover or thoroughly wet the day's dose for about 10-15 minutes will start to break down the psilocybin and the Chitin and will make your dose that much more digestible and bioavailable (called lemon tek).

When ready to dose, you can add enough water to make it like it is lemonade. Mushroom powder tends to be very hydrophobic so you may need to mix it thoroughly with a spoon and you may need to really scrape all the medicine that sticks into the glass to make sure you get your full dose.

6. INTENTION SETTING & MANAGING EXPECTATIONS

Setting an intention for your course of treatment can be very helpful because it keeps you focused on the fact that microdosing is for healing. It also will help you to track any progress you may gain during your course of treatment. An intention is not an expectation and so the more open ended your intention the better. The more inquisitive your intention the better.

If you go into microdosing with very specific expectations you will shut down the magic of the mushrooms because this medicine can work in mysterious ways. Part of what the medicine does is creates plasticity/flexibility in our brains. If we become fixed on how healing MUST occur for us, we may miss new ways of finding healing.

Healing via microdosing can be a very subtle and slow process. If you remain very curious about the process you will notice more happening. If you become very demanding of the process and the results you'd like to see then you will surely miss a lot of small subtle changes that you may not be able to explain intellectually but will permeate your being and your body.





7. MAKING SPACE TO SUPPORT THE PROCESS

Create space in your life to the extent humanly possible in order to observe the medicine doing its thing. Ways to do this is to ask for space whenever needed from your family and friends in order to be more present to the changes that will happen.

Making space for the medicine also means giving yourself permission to be extra cranky, to be extra tired and need more rest, to be more sensitive, to be more open, and to be more vulnerable. It means making room for the entire spectrum of emotions from sadness to utter joy and not cling to them as though they are a new permanent state or an identity for you.

8. INTEGRATION

WHAT IS INTEGRATION?

Integration is a process of learning from and applying what is revealed in the work with medicines to your daily life. Integration is the most important process of this work, because, without it, the work does not truly fulfill its purpose. The teachings and changes that result can be both amazing and subtle. The success of your inner work will be reflected in the changes you will see in your thinking and behavior.

HEALTHY EXPECTATIONS

You may have some very difficult days of confrontation, and you may have some exquisite days of contentment. Difficult days do not indicate the process is not working. On the contrary, it may indicate a vital process of sensitization of the emotions.

During the period of integration, it is ideal to allow yourself to:

- Express your emotions in whatever way you can, but especially verbally
- Be in a bad mood
- Make mistakes
- Cry / Whine / Be sad
- Ask for a lot of space from others

THE THREE AREAS OF INTEGRATION

Spiritual

- What are you learning about yourself (both positive and negative)?
- What core beliefs have you discovered?
- Are these beliefs hindering or helping?
- Do they align with your core values?
- What would be the consequences (both positive and negative) of letting go of some of these beliefs?
- And how would you feel if you let go of them?

Emotional

- What kinds of emotions are arising?
- How do you feel about these emotions?
- How is your view of these emotions different?
- What could you change in your environment or relationships to better manage these emotions?

Physical

- How do the emotions you are discovering manifest physically?
- What kinds of practices or movements could help you process these emotions and the physical after effects?
- Is there anything you feel needs to change in your physical environment?

HOW TO SUPPORT YOUR INTEGRATION

PROCESS

Your self-care regimen will support you greatly in this process:

- Meditation: zazen, vipassana, mindfulness, guided, transcendental, any kind
- Movement with meditation: Yoga, Taiji, Qigong
- Breathing techniques
- Exercise: Hiking, cycling, martial arts
- Arts and self-expression: Art, dance, singing, music, writing.
- Good nutrition. Eating fresh vegetables and fruits and avoiding processed foods

- Time in nature: camping, hiking, gardening
- Listening to medicine music to connect and remember your psychedelic experience
- Keeping a daily log of how you feel and your observations

OTHER RECOMMENDED SUPPORTS:

- Psychotherapy
- Acupuncture
- Massage

HOW CAN I SUPPORT YOU?

If you need personalized assistance or would like microdose coaching/integration sessions contact Ameyalli at ameyalli@ameyalli.space



AMEYALLI

ameyalli.space

